ANDONG HUA

hua.andong1997@gmail.com ⋄ +1 3109621201 ⋄ dongxzz.github.io/website/

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara *Jan. 2024 – June. 2027 (expected)*

Ph.D. Candidate, Final Year | Advisor: Prof. Yao Qin | Trustworthy & Multimodal LLMs, AI for Healthcare

University of California, Los Angeles *Sept. 2020 – Jun. 2022*

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering, GPA: **3.95/4.0**

University of Nottingham *Sept. 2016 – Jun. 2020*

B.Eng. in Electrical and Electronic Engineering (2+2), GPA: **85/100**; Rank: **1/160 (Year 3)**

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Tang, K.*, **Hua, A.***, Qian, C., Tiwari, S., and Qin, Y. SFT-as-Context Mitigates Forgetting in Supervised Fine-tuning. **under review**.

Hua, A., Bishop, C., Mordatch, I., Hosseini, A., Gu, J., Faust, A., Roelofs, R., and Qin, Y. TokenSwap: Benchmarking and Reducing the Modality Gap in Multimodal LLMs. **NeurIPS 2026**.

Hua, A.*, Tang, K.*, Gu, C., Gu, J., Wong, E., and Qin, Y. Flaw or Artifact? Rethinking Prompt Sensitivity in Evaluating LLMs. **EMNLP 2025 Main Track**.

Hua, A.*, Dhaliwal, M. P.*, Burke, R., Pullela, L., and Qin, Y., NutriBench: A Dataset for Evaluating Large Language Models on Nutrition Estimation from Meal Descriptions. **ICLR 2025**

Hua, A., Gu, J., Xue, Z., Carlini, N., Wong, E., and Qin, Y., Initialization Matters for Adversarial Transfer Learning, **CVPR 2024**

RESEARCH AND INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

University of California, Santa Barbara *Sept. 2026–Present*

World Modeling for Personalized Glucose Forecasting

- Developing an action-conditioned world model that forecasts four hour glucose trajectories from historical CGM and actions, planned interventions, and retrieved analogs from the same patient.
- Building a glucose forecasting benchmark from 5.8 million longitudinal records collected over four weeks from 493 adults with type 1 diabetes, including glucose, meals, exercise, and basal and bolus insulin.

Amazon | Applied Scientist Intern | AWS Fundamental Research *June–Sept. 2026*

RL Credit Assignment for LLM Agents

- Demonstrated that PPO critics primarily act as turn-level credit assigners.
- Quantified turn-level credit assignment using advantage similarity, and demonstrated that higher similarity to ground-truth advantages strongly correlates with better policy performance.
- Identified complementary strengths of GRPO and PPO in capturing advantage level and shape, respectively, and combined them through level–shape decomposition to achieve the best performance.

Amazon | Applied Scientist Intern | Smart Vehicle Team *June–Sept. 2025*

Prompt Optimization

- Developed prompt optimization methods using learned guidelines and error categorization, improving accuracy by 20% and supporting production use across multiple Amazon teams.
- Introduced an online prompt optimization framework that achieved state-of-the-art results while reducing computation by over 10×.

TuSimple | Research Engineer | Deep Perception *July 2022–Feb. 2023*

- *Video Segmentation Co-training.* Developed and trained a multitask U-Net with a shared encoder and task-specific heads, using FP16 for efficient distributed training and inference.
- *Interactive Segmentation.* Built an interactive segmentation tool that helps annotators create masks more efficiently, reducing the required clicks by up to 10×.